



Course Outline

ECON 313: Intermediate Macroeconomics (Summer 2026)

Instructor: Sonan Memon; smemon@uoregon.edu

Housekeeping:

July-20-August-16 2026: 3 lectures per week, each lasting for 1 hour, 30 minutes. This is a virtual, asynchronous course, where the recordings will be posted.

Office Hours: Virtually available upon request by email: smemon@uoregon.edu. If there is student demand, I can hold virtual office hours at a designated time, once every week.

Course GE:

TBA.

Course Learning Objectives and Pedagogical Approach:

This is an intermediate macroeconomics course for sophomores or juniors.

In this course, students are introduced to the art of macroeconomic modeling with a mathematically rigorous approach. Many workhorse macroeconomic models such as Solow Model, Neoclassical model and New Keynesian model will be covered, along with optimal fiscal and monetary policy analysis.

A micro-founded approach is taken throughout the course, consistent with Lucas critique and modern macroeconomic theory. A novel feature of this undergraduate course is the fact that distinctions are made between short run, medium run and long run. This is based on the approach taken by the brilliant textbook of [Garlin, 2021](#).

Students will also be introduced to some basic topics in time series: calculating growth rates, rolling window growth rates, rolling volatility measures, methods for trend, cycle decomposition such as HP filter and linear trend decomposition etc.

Course Prerequisites:

EC 202Z; MATH 241 or MATH 251Z; EC 311 is strongly recommended.

Mathematical appendices of [Garlin, 2021](#) should be enough. For further assistance, you may refer to [SimonBlume, 1994](#).

Grading Break up and Policy:

- 4 Assignments (30% of Grade).
- Mid-Term after two weeks (30% of Grade).
- Final: Last week (40% of Grade).

Academic Integrity:

Of course, you will be reported immediately to the SCCS (The University of Oregon (UO) Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards) if you engage in any cheating, plagiarism or violate academic integrity in any material manner, as determined by the instructor and in line with university policy.

Textbooks:

- **Main Textbook:** Garin, J., Lester, R., & Sims, E. (2021). Intermediate Macroeconomics. https://www3.nd.edu/~esims1/gls_textbook.html.
- **Reference 1:** Carlin, W., & Soskice, D. W. (2024). Macroeconomics: Institutions, Instability, and Inequality. Oxford University Press, USA.
- **Reference 2:** Jones, C. I. (2020). Macroeconomics, 5th edition.
- **Reference 3:** Chugh, Sanjay. (2015). Modern Macroeconomics. MIT Press.

Additional Readings (Not Required):

1. Friedman, M. (1953). The methodology of positive economics. Essays in positive economics, 3(3), 145-178.
2. *Mankiw, N. G. (2006). The macroeconomist as scientist and engineer. Journal of Economic Perspectives, 20(4), 29-46.
3. *Chari, V. V. (1998). Nobel laureate Robert E. Lucas, Jr.: architect of modern macroeconomics. Journal of Economic Perspectives, 12(1), 171-186.
4. Lucas, R. E. (1976). Econometric policy evaluation: A critique. In Carnegie-Rochester conference series on public policy (Vol. 1, No. 1, pp. 19-46).
5. *Christiano, Lawrence J., Martin S. Eichenbaum, and Mathias Trabandt. 2018. On DSGE Models. Journal of Economic Perspectives, 32 (3): 113-40.

6. *Gorton, G. B. (2010). Slapped by the invisible hand: The panic of 2007. Oxford University Press.
7. Gennaioli, N., & Shleifer, A. (2020). A Crisis of Beliefs. Princeton University Press.
8. Curtin, R. T. (2019). Consumer expectations: Micro foundations and macro impact. Cambridge University Press.
9. Reinhart, C. M., & Rogoff, K. S. (2009). This time is different: Eight centuries of financial folly. Princeton University Press.
10. Mian, A., & Sufi, A. (2015). House of debt: How they (and you) caused the Great Recession, and how we can prevent it from happening again. University of Chicago Press.
11. Tirole, J. (2017). Economics for the common good. Princeton University Press.
12. Rodrik, D. (2015). Economics rules: The rights and wrongs of the dismal science. WW Norton & Company.
13. Heilbroner, R. L. (2011). The worldly philosophers: The lives, times and ideas of the great economic thinkers. Simon and Schuster.
14. *Kuttner, K. N. (2018). Outside the box: Unconventional monetary policy in the great recession and beyond. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 32(4), 121-46.
15. Caballero, R. J., Farhi, E., & Gourinchas, P. O. (2017). The safe assets shortage conundrum. *Journal of Economic Perspectives*, 31(3), 29-46.
16. *Admati, A. R., & Hellwig, M. F. (2019). Bank Leverage, Welfare, and Regulation. Rock Center for Corporate Governance at Stanford University Working Paper, (235).
17. *Admati, A. R. (2016). Rethinking Financial Regulation: How confusion has prevented progress. *Progress and Confusion: The State of Macroeconomic Policy*, 61.
18. *Bank for International Settlements. (2011). Basel III: a global regulatory framework for more resilient banks and banking systems. BIS. <https://www.bis.org/>.

Outline of Syllabus

1. **Introduction (Lec 1):** Course Overview, Philosophy of Macroeconomics and History of Macroeconomic Thought (chapters 2-3 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).
2. **Macroeconomic Data (Lec 2):** Defining Macroeconomic Data (chapter 1 [Garlin, 2021](#)) along with hands on exercises in R regarding basic techniques of time-series.
3. **The Long Run (Lec 3-4):** Stylized Facts about Economic Growth, Understanding Cross-Country Income Differences and Solow Model (chapters 4, 5 and 7 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).
4. **The Microeconomics of Macroeconomics (Lec 5-6):** Dynamic consumption saving decisions and Production, Labor Demand, Investment, Labor Supply and Monopolistic Competition (chapters 9, 10, 12 and 16 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).
5. **Business Cycles (Lec 7-12):** Neo-classical and New Keynesian Model (chapters 18-21 and 24 to 27 from [Garlin, 2021](#)).